

Wine Cap Mushroom Cultivation Guide

1. What Are Wine Cap Mushrooms?

Also called garden giants, these mushrooms grow outdoors in shaded, moist environments using wood chips or straw. They are easy to cultivate and help enrich soil.

2. Materials & Site Prep

- Wine Cap spawn (5 lb covers ~25 sq ft)
- Substrate: aged hardwood chips or straw
- Optional cardboard base to block weeds
- Select a shady or partially shaded area

3. Building the Mushroom Bed

1. Clear weeds and lay cardboard (optional).
2. Spread substrate 3-8" deep.
3. Moisten substrate thoroughly.
4. Mix spawn into layers.
5. Add mulch layer (optional).
6. Keep bed consistently damp.

4. Growth & Fruiting

- Mushrooms appear in 3-6 months (spring plantings).
- Fruiting triggered by rain or cooler temps.
- Expect first harvest by June if planted in fall.

5. Harvesting

- Pick when caps open (4-6" ideal).
- Twist or cut at base.
- Store in breathable container.

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6. Maintenance & Yield

- Water regularly.
- Refresh substrate yearly.
- Yields: 2-5 lb per 10 sq ft annually.

Quick Timeline Summary

Step	Action
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Prep Site	Clear & lay cardboard
Substrate	3-8" of chips or straw
Spawn	Mix evenly through layers
Watering	Keep damp, not soaked
Fruiting	3-6 months post-planting
Harvest	Twist or cut mushrooms
Refresh Bed	Add new chips yearly